

Repatterning the Missing Experience - Part 1

with Mariah Rooney and Kai Cheng Thom

AGENDA

Somatic Attunement + Somatic
Alliance

Shape/Countershape

Somatic Strategies

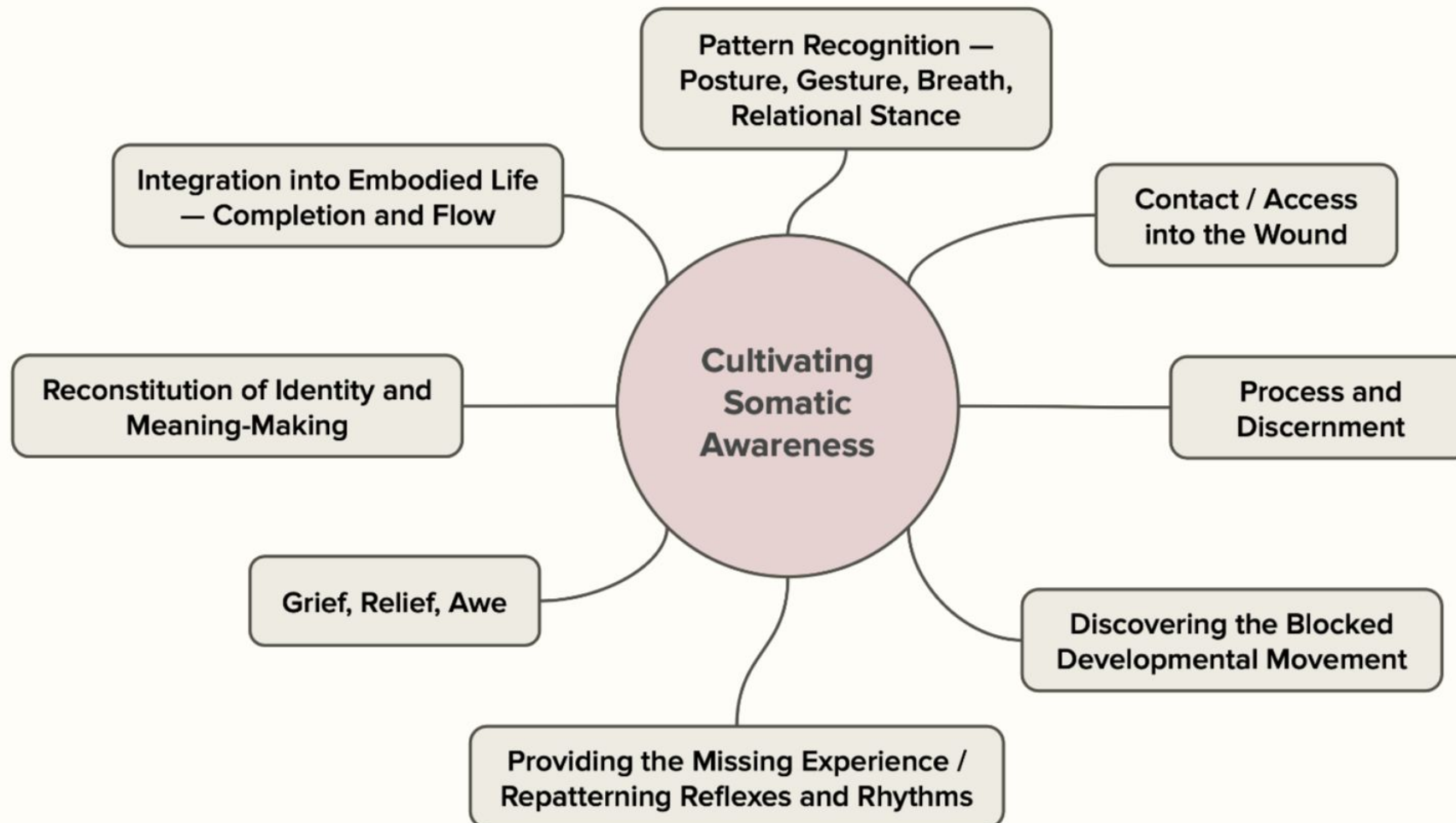
Q & A

Breakout Sessions



SOMATIC ATTUNEMENT + SOMATIC ALLIANCE

The 8-Phase Map of Developmental Repair



Somatic Attunement

- Ability to “be with” another individual’s on an embodied level in a way that is experienced as both connected and caring - can include conversational elements but is largely pre-linguistic (prosody, tone, gesture, posture)
- “Centered bodies center bodies” - when we arrive in the moment of relational contact with another, our nervous systems influence one another through a cascading loop of micro-signals (entrainment)
- To attune to another, we must be **both** connected **and** caring, able to receive whatever is emerging from the other’s soma without overwhelming them or being overwhelmed - our somatic capacity and somatic bandwidth must be wide so that we can hold our own coherence while demonstrating connection to the other soma’s state of feeling
- We can practice somatic attunement at any time, but structured exercises/practices/games can draw in the client’s collaboration and empowerment by making the process conscious and explicit
- **Demo & Q&A**

The background of the slide is a solid brown color. It is decorated with white, hand-drawn style wavy lines. One line starts in the top right corner and curves downwards. Another line starts in the bottom left corner and curves upwards. A third line starts in the bottom right corner and curves upwards. These lines create a sense of movement and organic form.

BREAKOUT SESSIONS

Spectrum of Consent

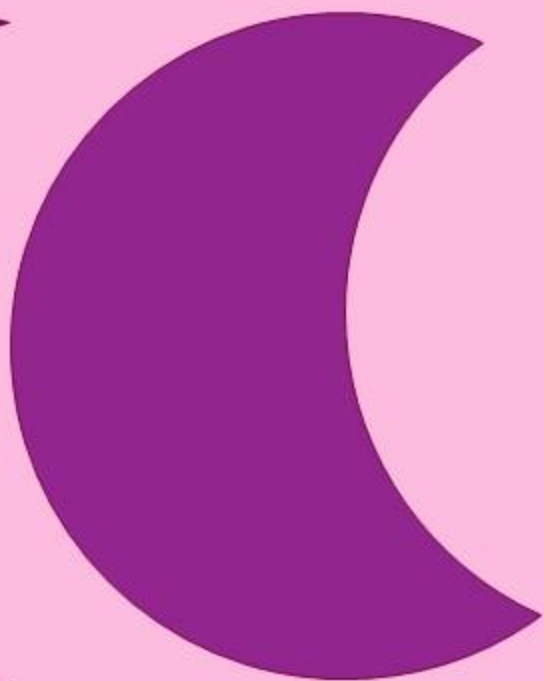
By Kai Cheng Thom, inspired by the work of Betty Martin

Enduring



*This is hurting me but
I don't feel able to say
no*

Tolerating



*This is something I
am putting up with*

Willing



*This is something I am
"okay" or neutral
about*

Wanting



This makes me feel good

Circle of Response

by Kai Cheng
Thom

**FOR
YOU**

MAYBE

*I want to try this
for myself if...*

NO

*I do not want this
for myself*

YES

*Yes, I want this for
myself*

**I CHANGED
MY MIND**

YES

*Yes, I'm willing to
do this for you*

**FOR
THEM**

MAYBE

*I might be
willing to do this
for you if...*

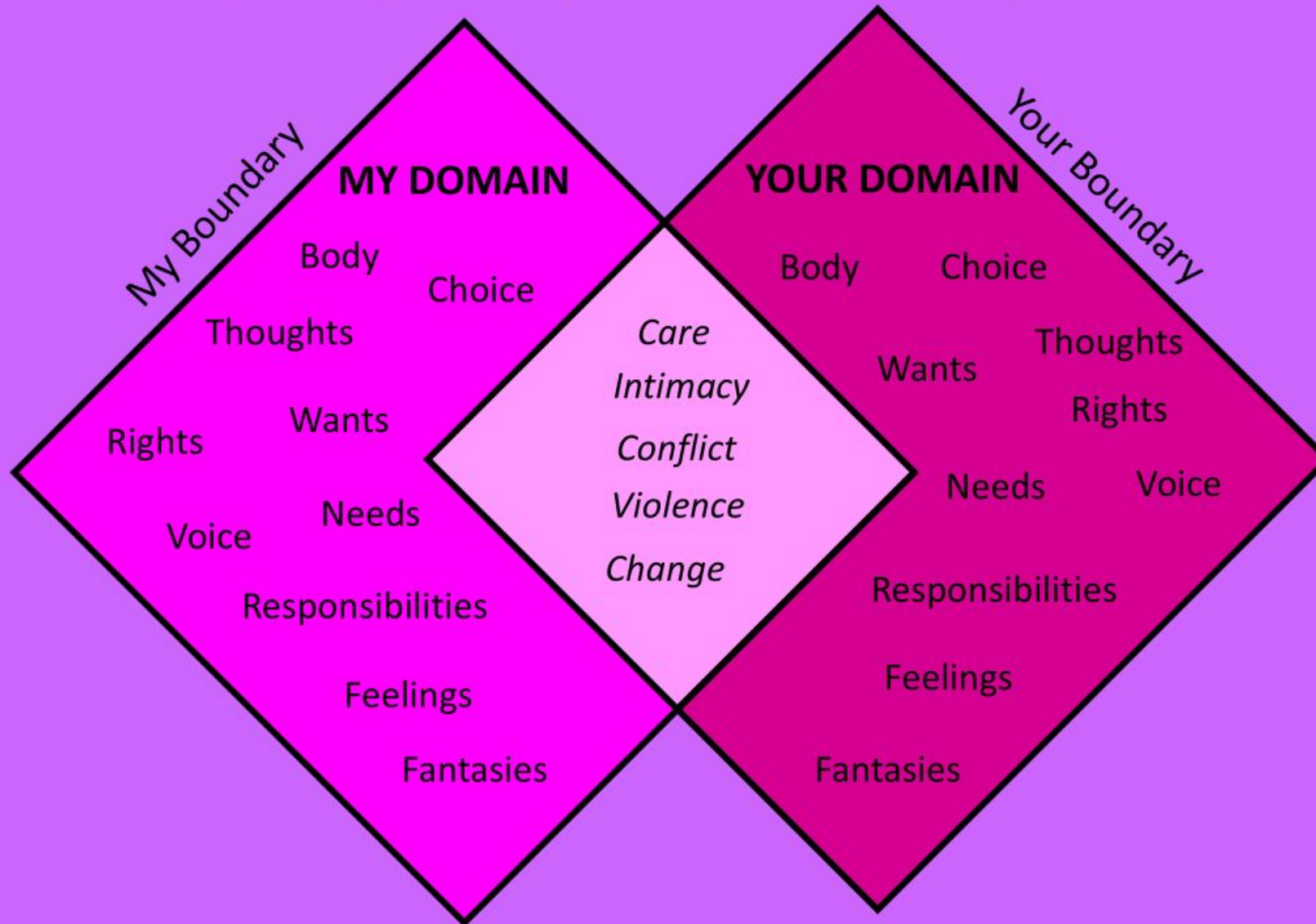
NO

*I am not
willing to do
this for you*

**I CHANGED
MY MIND**

Understanding Boundaries

by Kai Cheng Thom, adapted from the work of Betty Martin





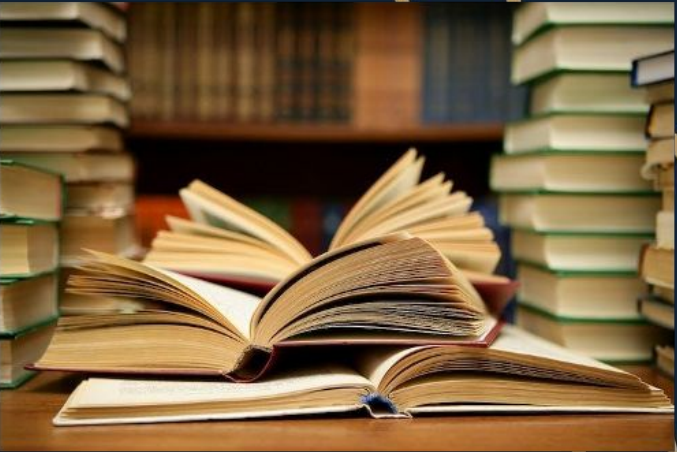
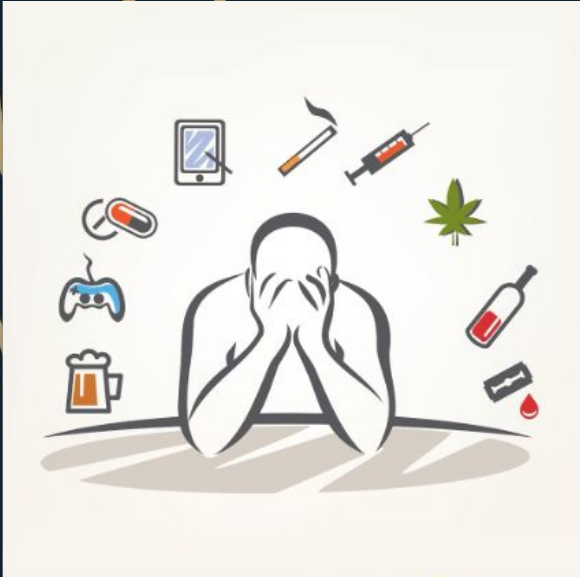
SHAPE/COUNTERSHAPE

SHAPE/COUNTERSHAPE



SHAPE/COUNTERSHAPE OF DISTRESS







SOMATIC STRATEGIES

MAKING “CONTACT”: CONTACT STATEMENTS

KEY FEATURES OF CONTACT STATEMENTS

- **They are simple.** Overly complex language pulls clients into cognitive processing and interrupts the experiential, somatic unfolding you're aiming to support
- **They carry a tone of curiosity.** Without agenda or direction, your inflection communicates openness and flexibility, signaling that you are not leading them toward a specific interpretation or technique
- **They reflect both physicality and language.** How the person speaks, moves, gestures, or makes contact with their body offers essential information about their internal organization, not just the content of their words
- **They track the present-moment experience.** A contact statement meets the client where they are, validating and noticing what is emerging now
- **They convey curiosity, compassion, and encouragement.** The therapist's stance communicates interest in and care for the client's unfolding experience (client's can borrow this from us)
- **They are flexible rather than questions.** This keeps the client oriented toward direct experience rather than shifting into explanation or performance. A note that questions are *a/so* helpful!

EXAMPLES: CONTACT STATEMENTS

- **Posture:** *"It looks like your body is ready to spring out of the seat," or "I notice your gaze is down right now"*
- **Gestures:** "It seems like your hand is pushing something away"
- **Verbal pacing:** "It sounds like things feel rushed or sped up inside"
- **Eyes / contact:** "I notice it's hard to make contact as you say that"
- **In family/relationship therapy:** "It seems hard to look at them while you're talking about this"
- **Shifts in energy/state:** "It seems like your energy dropped when you started talking about your family"
- **Quality/tone of voice:** "There's a tone of anger - or maybe confusion? - in your voice as you say that"
- **Verbal observations:** "I'm noticing that you end a lot of sentences with a question mark. Is that something you're aware of/notice too?"
- **Hesitation:** "You're saying very little about _____. It sounds like it might be hard to talk about"
- **Defensive strategy/adaptation:** "I noticed you crossed your arms and turned your head away. I'm wondering if something in you/a part of you might be pulling back or wanting to hold those feelings aside"



DEMONSTRATION



BREAKOUT SESSIONS

Somatic Alliance & Somatic Solidarity

- This is a practice descended from the lineage of Somatic Sex Education and the teaching of Caffyn Jesse, as well as Generative Somatics and Staci Haines, that can be applied to a wide range of trauma healing situations
 - Can be particularly helpful for working with non-verbal and developmental trauma
- Somatic alliance is about inviting the client (or receiver)'s somatic “shape” to receive mirroring, attunement, care and support from the body of another person
- This intervention is not about directing or pushing towards any particular outcome other than exploring what happens when “nervous systems show up for other nervous systems” - what happens when our survival shapes no longer need to be alone?
- What happens when the body is empowered to receive what it needs? What it *wants*?
- **Demonstration & Q&A**



QUESTIONS